

# VIKASIT ODISHA, A VISION FOR PROSPERITY & GROWTH

Odisha was one of the poorest states in the country around three decades ago. Whatever was left was washed away by the Supercyclone in 1999. Though the state has come out of that ignominy, its journey of economic prosperity has rather been slower than expected in these years despite political stability.

However, Odisha is now daring to dream of becoming a developed state or 'Vikasit Odisha' in the coming decade in line with PM Modi's vision of a developed India or 'Vikasit Bharat'. The state is rather raring to become the growth engine of Vikasit Bharat by 2036, the centenary year of its formation as the first linguistic state of India.

'Vikasit Odisha' embodies the aspiration of transforming the culturally rich and resource-abundant state into a model of inclusive and sustainable development. Rooted in the state's heritage and natural wealth, the vision aims to ensure economic prosperity, social equality and technological advancement for every citizen.

The idea of 'Vikasit Odisha' is also aligned with India's broader developmental goals and the global sustainable development goals (SDGs). It envisions Odisha as:

- A hub of industrial growth and economic opportunities.
- A state with robust infrastructure and smart cities.
- A centre for high-quality education and healthcare.
- A leader in sustainable development and environmental conservation.
- A place where cultural heritage and technological innovation coexist.

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### ITS KEY OBJECTIVES INCLUDE:

1. Economic growth: Boost the GDP of the state by fostering industries, agriculture, tourism and IT.
2. Poverty alleviation: Reduce poverty through employment generation and skill development.
3. Education and healthcare: Strengthen access to quality education and world-class healthcare facilities.
4. Infrastructure development: Modernise transportation, energy, water and digital infrastructure.
5. Environmental sustainability: Conserve natural resources and adopt green practices.

### INDUSTRIAL GROWTH

Odisha has abundant natural resources, including minerals like iron ore, coal and bauxite. By leveraging these resources, Odisha can (1) attract investments in steel, aluminium and other industries, (2) expand downstream industries to generate value-added products, and (3) promote special economic zones (SEZs) and MSMEs to boost employment.

### INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT

Odisha has to expand its rail and road connectivity to remote regions, develop its ports like Paradip and Dhamara as world-class shipping hubs as well as strengthen the air connectivity to attract investments and tourism.

The state will have to transform cities like Bhubaneswar, Cuttack and Rourkela into smart cities with efficient transportation, waste management and green spaces.

On the digital front, it has to ensure universal access to high-speed internet and promote e-governance initiatives to enhance transparency and efficiency.

### TOURISM WITH INDUSTRY STATUS

Odisha's rich heritage, including iconic temples such as the Konark Sun Temple and Puri's Jagannath Temple as well as other popular destinations like Chilika Lake and Puri sea beach can make it a global tourism hotspot. Investment in tourism infrastructure, hospitality and marketing can drive growth in this sector.

### AGRICULTURE & RURAL ECONOMY

With fertile lands and diverse climates, Odisha has immense potential in the field of agriculture and fisheries. Initiatives like promoting organic farming and food processing industries, expanding irrigation systems and facilitating access to modern agricultural technologies will harness that potential and bring about rural prosperity.